

SPECIAL BOARD MEETING MINUTES

Monday, April 20, 2026 at 5:00pm

The Board of Education of School District No. 39 (Vancouver) met in room 114 (the Boardroom), VSB Education Centre, 1580 West Broadway, Vancouver, B.C. on Monday, April 20, 2026, at 5:00pm. The meeting was live streamed.

Trustees Present:

Victoria Jung, Chairperson
Janet Fraser, Vice-Chairperson
Lois Chan-Pedley
Alfred Chien
Preeti Faridkot
Suzie Mah
Jennifer Reddy
Christopher Richardson

Trustees Absent with regrets:

Joshua Zhang

Senior Team Members Present:

Helen McGregor, Superintendent of Schools
Flavia Coughlan, Secretary Treasurer
Pedro da Silva, Associate Superintendent
Maureen McRae-Stanger, Associate Superintendent
Janis Myers, Associate Superintendent
Alison Ogden, Associate Superintendent
Michael Gray, Executive Director, Employee Services
Jessie Gresley-Jones, Executive Director, Facilities
Lorelei Russell, Executive Director, Finance
Patricia MacNeil, Director of Communications
Judy Mah, Executive Coordinator (Recorder)

Also Present:

1. CALL MEETING TO ORDER

1.1. Land Acknowledgement

The Chairperson called the meeting to order. She acknowledged with deep gratitude and respect, we are honoured to be learning and unlearning on the ancestral and unceded lands of the xʷməθkʷəy̓əm (Musqueam), Skwxwú7mesh Úxwumixw (Squamish Nation) and səliwətał (Tsleil-Waututh Nation).

1.2. Opening Remarks

The Chairperson reviewed meeting decorum then welcomed trustees and staff.

In her remarks, the Chair recognized John Chenoweth, an Indigenous Educator, trustee and Director of the BC School Trustee Association, for his presentation to fellow educators on integrating Indigenous learnings into the classroom.

She thanked everyone who had provided input and participated in the financial planning process during the public engagement period, noting that the feedback received assists the Board in making informed decisions. She encouraged all participants to put their phones away or on silent to ensure effective engagement and interactive discussion.

Following introductions, Trustee Mah requested to amend the agenda to include a notice of motion that she had submitted pertaining to the reinstatement of the living wage.

In response to a question from the Board Chair, the Secretary-Treasurer advised that the notice of motion relates to a labour matter and, given that collective bargaining is currently underway, would be more appropriately considered at a private meeting of the Board.

Trustee Mah asked to challenge the Chair, which was seconded by Trustee Reddy.

The Secretary Treasurer responded to a procedural question. Following discussion, trustees voted on sustaining the Chair.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, A. Chien, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, C. Richardson

Against: S. Mah, J. Reddy

Abstained: V. Jung

2. NEW BUSINESS

2.1. 2026-2027 Financial Plan Engagement Update

The Superintendent introduced the 2026-2027 Financial Plan Engagement Update, then asked the Communications Director to present the Financial Plan Engagement Summary Report which had been posted to the VSB website.

The Communications Director explained that the report had been provided to assist the Board when considering priorities for the 2026-2027 financial plan. She reviewed the key principles that guided the engagement process such as the VSB Education Plan, the Framework for Enhancing Student Learning and standards set by the International Association of Public Participation, then outlined the various groups that participated in the engagement process, and how the information had been shared with the Board. She concluded her presentation by highlighting some of the priorities that had been shared by participants, noting that these priorities reflect patterns seen in past years.

The Board Chair confirmed that trustees had no questions regarding the information provided.

2.2. Trustee Motions Regarding the Draft 2026-2027 Financial Plan

The Board Chair introduced the item, *Trustee Motions Regarding the Draft 2026-2027 Financial Plan*, then asked trustees who had submitted a notice of motion to present their proposed motions.

2.2.1 Notice of Motion from Trustee Reddy: Budget 2026/2027 Increasing Out of School Care Spaces & VSB Recruitment and Retention Efforts

Trustee Reddy presented her proposed motion.

Main Motion

Moved by J. Reddy, seconded by S. Mah, that VSB allocate \$75,000 (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct a feasibility survey and study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, with prioritized (but not exclusive) enrolment for current and prospective VSB employees, and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility work include:

- a district-wide survey of VSB families and employees to identify unmet OOSC needs, including identification of VSB staff requiring care;
- assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space;
- identifying staffing models and labour considerations, within existing collective agreements and regulatory frameworks, in consultation with employee groups;

- enrolment prioritization approaches for VSB employees, applying an equity lens; and estimated costs, revenues, and operational requirements of a multi-site pilot including space upgrades and program materials and supplies.

Be it further resolved that staff report back with an interim report by June 2026 and final report by September 15, 2026, on:

- baseline survey results and a plan for a one-year follow-up survey;
- feasibility, costs, and proposed scale of a multi-site pilot, including potential number of spaces and sites;
- employee-group interest and facility considerations; and
- anticipated impacts on recruitment and retention of VSB staff.

Trustee Reddy reviewed her rationale for the motion as presented on page 4 of the agenda package and referenced an open letter from parents expressing their support for this motion.

Trustee Fraser asked to move an amendment to the motion, as detailed below:

Amendment #1

Moved by J. Fraser, seconded by L. Chan-Pedley, that VSB allocate **up to \$75,000** (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct a feasibility ~~survey and~~ study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering **high quality, inclusive, affordable and cost-neutral** licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, ~~with prioritized (but not exclusive) enrolment for current and prospective VSB employees, and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.~~

Be it further resolved that the feasibility work include:

- ~~a district wide survey of VSB families and employees to identify unmet OOSC needs, including identification of VSB staff requiring care;~~
- assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space;
- identifying staffing models and labour considerations, within existing collective agreements and regulatory frameworks, in consultation with employee groups;
- ~~enrolment prioritization approaches for VSB employees, applying an equity lens; and~~
- estimated costs, revenues, and operational requirements of a multi-site pilot including space upgrades and program materials and supplies.

And when the feasibility study is complete and the results available, that the board consider additional work, for example prioritized enrolment for VSB employees and a survey.

Be it further resolved **that the feasibility study be completed during the 2026-2027 school year, and that staff report back with an update at the June 2026 Facilities Planning Committee meeting.** ~~by June 2026 and final report by September 15, 2026, on:~~

- ~~baseline survey results and a plan for a one year follow up survey;~~
- ~~feasibility, costs, and proposed scale of a multi-site pilot, including potential number of spaces and sites;~~
- ~~employee group interest and facility considerations; and~~
- ~~anticipated impacts on recruitment and retention of VSB staff.~~

She reviewed and provided rationale for the proposed changes outlined in her amendment.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions and Trustee Fraser responded.

Amendment to the Amendment:

Trustee Mah asked to move an amendment to the amendment, reading out the proposed change.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy to add the wording “and ensuring that utilized classroom spaces contain safe and secure storage for teachers;” after “- assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space;”

She provided rationale for her amendment. The Secretary Treasurer responded to a procedural question, advising that if the amendment to the amendment were to pass, but the amendment to the main motion were to fail, the amendment to the amendment could be brought forward again.

Trustees voted on the amendment to the amendment.

CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY

Trustees returned to the amendment to the main motion as revised.

Amendment #1 (as amended):

Therefore be it resolved that VSB allocate **up to \$75,000** (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct a feasibility ~~survey and~~ study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering **high quality, inclusive, affordable and cost-neutral** licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, ~~with prioritized (but not exclusive) enrolment for current and prospective VSB employees,~~ and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility work include:

- ~~• a district wide survey of VSB families and employees to identify unmet OOSC needs, including identification of VSB staff requiring care;~~
- assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space **and ensuring that utilized classroom spaces contain safe and secure storage for teachers;**
- identifying staffing models and labour considerations, within existing collective agreements and regulatory frameworks, in consultation with employee groups;
- ~~• enrolment prioritization approaches for VSB employees, applying an equity lens; and~~
- estimated costs, revenues, and operational requirements of a multi-site pilot including space upgrades and program materials and supplies.

And when the feasibility study is complete and the results available, that the board consider additional work, for example prioritized enrolment for VSB employees and a survey.

Be it further resolved **that the feasibility study be completed during the 2026-2027 school year, and that staff report back with an update at the June 2026 Facilities Planning Committee meeting. by June 2026 and final report by September 15, 2026, on:**

- ~~• baseline survey results and a plan for a one year follow up survey;~~
- ~~• feasibility, costs, and proposed scale of a multi-site pilot, including potential number of spaces and sites;~~
- ~~• employee group interest and facility considerations; and~~
- ~~• anticipated impacts on recruitment and retention of VSB staff.~~

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien, S. Mah, J. Reddy

Abstained: P. Faridkot

Trustees returned to the main motion as amended and further discussion ensued.

Main Motion as Amended:

That VSB allocate up to \$75,000 (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct a feasibility study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering high quality, inclusive, affordable and cost-neutral licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility work include:

assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space and ensuring that utilized classroom spaces contain safe and secure storage for teachers;

- identifying staffing models and labour considerations, within existing collective agreements and regulatory frameworks, in consultation with employee groups; and
- estimated costs, revenues, and operational requirements of a multi-site pilot including space upgrades and program materials and supplies.
- And when the feasibility study is complete and the results available, that the board consider additional work, for example prioritized enrolment for VSB employees and a survey.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility study be completed during the 2026-2027 school year, and that staff report back with an update at the June 2026 Facilities Planning Committee meeting.

Amendment #1 to Main Motion as Amended

Board Chair Jung asked to move an amendment to the amended motion. She passed the Chair to Vice-Chair Fraser so that she could move her amendment.

Moved by V. Jung, seconded by P. Faridkot, to modify the first sentence of the motion as detailed below:

That **VSB allocate ask MECC to provide funding of** up to \$75,000 (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct (1) a feasibility study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering high quality, inclusive, affordable and cost-neutral licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.

She provided rationale for the motion and discussion ensued. Trustees voted on the amendment to the motion.

DEFEATED

For: A. Chien, P. Faridkot, V. Jung

Against: L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Trustee Fraser passed the chair back to Board Chair Jung, who then called a recess at 6:04 pm. The meeting resumed at 6:15 pm.

Trustees returned to the main motion as amended.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and the Secretary Treasurer responded.

Amendment #2 to Main Motion as Amended:

Trustee Fraser asked to make an amendment to identify where the source of the funds would come from in the motion.

Moved by J. Fraser, seconded by L. Chan-Pedley, that the wording, “from operating contingency” be added following, that “ VSB allocate up to \$75,000”.

She provided rationale for the amendment.

In response to a trustee’s question, the Secretary Treasurer informed the Board that should the motion pass, it would leave the contingency reserve at approximately 6.5 million, which would be slightly lower than the minimum 1% mandated through policy.

Trustees voted on the amendment to the main motion as amended.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien, P. Faridkot

Amendment #3 to Main Motion as Amended:

Trustee Mah asked to make an amendment to the amended motion.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by C. Richardson, to add the wording, “ That upon completion of this feasibility study, we ask the MECC to provide funding to cover the costs of the feasibility study.” to the end of the motion.

Trustees provided comments.

The Board agreed to change the word, “we” to the Board.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by C. Richardson, to add the wording, “ That upon completion of this feasibility study, the Board ask the MECC to provide funding to cover the costs of the feasibility study.” to the end of the motion.

Following discussion, trustees voted on the amendment to the amended motion.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, V. Jung, S. Mah, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien, J. Reddy

Trustees returned the main motion as amended.

Main motion as amended:

Therefore be it resolved that VSB allocate up to \$75,000 from operating contingency (for consultant fees, supplies and miscellaneous costs) to conduct a feasibility study, in consultation with employee groups, on the planning, implementation, and costs of a VSB-operated pilot delivering high quality, inclusive, affordable and cost-neutral licensed school-age child care (OOSC) at multiple school sites, delivered where feasible by existing support staff, and aligned with provincial ChildCareBC expansion objectives.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility work include:

- **assessment of potential school sites and available space, including multipurpose rooms and suitable classroom space and ensuring that utilized classroom spaces contain safe and secure storage for teachers;**
- **identifying staffing models and labour considerations, within existing collective agreements and regulatory frameworks, in consultation with employee groups; and**
- **estimated costs, revenues, and operational requirements of a multi-site pilot including space upgrades and program materials and supplies.**

And when the feasibility study is complete and the results available, that the board consider additional work, for example prioritized enrolment for VSB employees and a survey.

Be it further resolved that the feasibility study be completed during the 2026-2027 school year, and that staff report back with an update at the June 2026 Facilities Planning Committee meeting.

That upon completion of this feasibility study, the Board ask the MECC to provide funding to cover the costs of the feasibility study.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, V. Jung, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien

2.2.2 Notice of Motion from Trustee Fraser: Learning Technology and Information Systems Plan

Trustee Fraser presented her proposed motion.

Moved by J. Fraser, seconded by C. Richardson, that the Board direct the superintendent to develop a Learning Technology and Information Systems Plan for trustees' consideration as part of the 2027-2028 financial planning process.

Trustees Fraser provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees asked questions and provided comments and Trustee Fraser responded.

In response to a trustee's question, the Superintendent noted that the plan would encompass all VSB programs, including K-12, adult education and staff needs.

CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY

2.2.3 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Increasing Additional Hours for Supervision Aides for the 2026 2027 School Year

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy, that the Board amend the 2026-2027 draft financial plan and budget to add up to 300 additional hours of Supervision Aide staffing for the 2026-2027 school year.

Trustees Mah provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

The Secretary Treasurer addressed trustees' questions about the potential cost should the motion be approved.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien, V. Jung

Trustee Jung asked to move a motion to clarify the funding source for the motion.

Moved by V. Jung, seconded by C. Richardson, that the Board approve the allocation of \$9200 from operating contingency to fund the additional 300 hours of Supervision Aide Staffing.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, V. Jung, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien

2.2.4 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Reinstatement of 3.0 FTE SSB Staffing for the 2026-2027 School Year

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion, requesting that wording regarding the funding source be added at the end of the motion. The Board agreed to the change.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy, that the Board amend the 2026-2027 draft financial plan and budget to reinstate 3.0 FTE SSB staffing for the 2026-2027 school year, and that the Board approve the allocation of \$257,019 from operating contingency to fund the additional 3 FTE SSB staffing.

Trustee Mah provided rationale for the motion. Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

DEFEATED

For: P. Faridkot, S. Mah, J. Reddy

Against: A. Chien, L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

2.2.5 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Teachers Teaching on Call Coverage for Resource Teachers from Day One of Absence

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy, that the VSB 2026-2027 budget fund the provision of teachers on call to replace absent Resource Teachers on their first day of absence and that this funding will come from a reduction in the Divisional Superintendent and Divisional Superintendent Office budgets and other areas in the budget that do not affect direct instruction to students.

Trustees Mah provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

Trustee Jung requested that the motion be amended to specify the funding source, and the change was accepted unanimously.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

That the VSB 2026-2027 budget fund the provision of teachers on call to replace absent Resource Teachers on their first day of absence and that this funding of \$2,697,552 will come from a reduction in the Divisional Superintendent and Divisional Superintendent Office budgets and other areas in the budget that do not affect direct instruction to students.

DEFEATED

For: S. Mah, J. Reddy

Against: A. Chien, L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

2.2.6 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Reinstatement of 1.0 FTE Teacher of the Visually Impaired and 1.0 FTE Hospital Homebound Teacher for the 2026 2027 School Year

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion, noting that the funding source should be included in the main motion.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy, that the Board amend the 2026-2027 draft financial plan and budget to reinstate 1.0 FTE Teacher of the Visually Impaired staffing and 1.0 FTE Hospital Homebound teacher staffing for the 2026-2027 school year and that the Board approve the allocation of \$280,778 from operating contingency to fund the additional 2.0 FTE teacher staffing.

Trustees Mah provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

DEFEATED

For: P. Faridkot, S. Mah, J. Reddy

Against: A. Chien, L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

2.2.7 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Reinstatement of 1.0 FTE District Teacher Librarian staffing for the 2026 2027 School Year

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion, which included details on the funding source.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by P. Faridkot, that the Board amend the 2026-2027 draft financial plan and budget to reinstate the 1.0 FTE District Teacher Librarian staffing for the 2026-2027 school year and that the Board approve the allocation of \$140,389 from operating contingency to fund the additional 1 FTE teacher staffing.

Trustees Mah provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

DEFEATED

For: A. Chien, P. Faridkot, S. Mah, J. Reddy

Against: L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

2.2.8 Notice of Motion from Trustee Mah: Full designation of City of Vancouver Food Grant for the 2026 2027 School Year

Trustee Mah presented her proposed motion.

Moved by S. Mah, seconded by J. Reddy, that the Board amend 2026-2027 draft financial plan and budget to reflect the full \$325,000 City of Vancouver food grant for the 2026-2027 school year as soon as the grant is confirmed by the City of Vancouver.

Trustees Mah provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

In response to a questions from trustees, the Secretary Treasurer explained that the motion would not result in any changes to the current financial plan, but should the City of Vancouver announce a new grant, the motion would allow for the budget to be amended and the funds to be allocated as soon as they are received instead of waiting for the amended budget process in February.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

CARRIED

For: L. Chan-Pedley, J. Fraser, V. Jung, S. Mah, J. Reddy, C. Richardson

Against: A. Chien

Abstained: P. Faridkot

2.2.9 Notice of Motion from Trustee Reddy: Increase Direct Classroom Support for Students with Disabilities or Diverse Abilities

Trustee Reddy presented her proposed motion.

Moved by J. Reddy, seconded by S. Mah, that the Board approve that any and all funding for students with disabilities or diverse abilities that is being spent on Principals and Vice Principals' salaries be redirected to direct classroom support for students with disabilities or diverse abilities. Any further increase in funding for inclusive education from MECC for 2026-2027 be spent directly on classroom support, not administrators nor redirected to surplus.

Trustees Reddy provided rationale for the motion, and discussion ensued.

Trustees provided comments and asked questions, and staff provided clarifying responses.

Following discussion, the Board voted on the motion.

In response to a trustee's question, the Secretary-Treasurer explained that the Board receives funding from the Ministry of Education and Child Care through the Classroom Enhancement Fund, which supports the additional resource teacher staffing required to meet collective agreement-stipulated staffing levels beyond what is provided through the operating fund. She further advised that, should the motion pass, the district would forgo approximately \$2.2 million in Ministry funding, as operating funds would be used to cover the cost of these positions.

DEFEATED

For: S. Mah, J. Reddy

Against: A. Chien, L. Chan-Pedley, P. Faridkot, J. Fraser, V. Jung, C. Richardson

The Chair thanked staff for their efforts in preparing the 2026-2027 financial plan.

3. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting adjourned by consensus at 7:55 pm.

Flavia Coughlan, Secretary Treasurer

Victoria Jung, Chairperson